

Chapter 128-3

After a while, Qi Jiao spoke again: "Is Chen Mian a painter?"

Qi Jun frowned. "How would I know? Want to search it up?"

"I already searched." Qi Jiao said, "Nothing came up. There was one result about some city's 'Three Good Student.'"¹

Qi Jun fell silent.

Qi Jiao placed the wrapped bouquet on the counter. Flowers of all colors vied for attention in splendid display, and the shop was filled with rich floral fragrance.

"Then why do you say she's a painter?" Qi Jun asked.

Qi Jiao pondered for a few seconds, then smiled. "Pure intuition."

Qi Jun didn't say anything more.

He had actually heard the name Chen Mian before.

When Qi Jiao had her high fever, she kept calling out: "Chen Mian... Chen Mian..."

Qi Jun had specifically gone to her school to investigate, but couldn't find this person.

At the time, their whole family was frightened, thinking Qi Jiao was in a secret relationship. But it turned out this person didn't exist at all.

When Qi Jiao woke up and recovered, they had also asked who Chen Mian was.

But Qi Jiao had looked bewildered and said, "This name sounds so familiar? But I don't think I know them."

Qi Jun couldn't be bothered to bring up this old matter again.

Qi Jiao sat among the fresh flowers, more gentle and beautiful than the flowers themselves.

That she could grow up safely was already enough.

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Wang Zhaozhao brought a bouquet of tulips when she came.

Liang Shi was busy in the kitchen wearing an apron, inviting them to sit down and eat.

Xiao Bai ran into the kitchen like an orangutan that had just escaped from the zoo, howling: "Wuwuwu, being able to see Sister Liang cook in my lifetime is simply like a Bodhisattva descending to save all living beings! Us mortals can only go 'awoo awoo'~"²

As she spoke, she leaned close to the counter emanating rich aromas. Liang Shi pushed her away. "Go away."

"Keep making a fuss." Wang Zhaozhao stood at the kitchen doorway with her arms crossed. "Bai Qi, were you a starving ghost reincarnated?"²

Being called by her full name, Xiao Bai shrank her neck sheepishly as if the nape of her fate had been pinched. "I was just purely craving... just a little bit."

"Can't I feed you enough at home every day?" Wang Zhaozhao said, "Is it necessary?"

"How can that be the same?!" Xiao Bai rarely stood her ground. "Food from home just isn't as good as food from outside."

"Fine then, don't eat the food at home anymore." Wang Zhaozhao scoffed lightly. "You're so spoiled."

Xiao Bai instantly caved. "Jiějie, I was wrong."

Liang Shi stood in front of the counter, steam from the pot drifting around her. If you looked carefully, you could see she was holding back laughter.

Wang Zhaozhao had been in the entertainment industry for so many years and was as sharp as they come. One glance and she knew what Liang Shi was doing.

She raised an eyebrow lightly. "Little one, what are you thinking about?"

Sister Wang wasn't actually that old—thirty-four years old, twelve years older than Xiao Bai and nine years older than Liang Shi.

But she had entered this industry early; she already had half a foot in the door while still in school.

Her seniority wasn't considered high, but her methods were ruthless enough—whether toward herself or others.

People in the industry often said that Wang Zhaozhao was like a venomous snake. If anyone got bitten by her, it would definitely be fatal.

In front of her, Liang Shi and Xiao Bai were completely outclassed.

So Sister Wang often called the two of them "little ones."

Though she only called them that during casual moments when they were teasing each other.

However, during the days when Liang Shi was in a coma, this term of address had become exclusive to Xiao Bai.

So at this moment, Xiao Bai immediately responded: "Huh? I'm thinking about how to kneel down and apologize."

"Go away." Sister Wang leaned against the doorframe, her voice light and airy. "I'm talking about the other one. What inappropriate thoughts are you having?"

Being called out, Liang Shi pinched her earlobe and said quietly, "You two just sounded like you were flirting."⁴

Having already gained some experience, Liang Shi naturally couldn't help but let her mind wander when hearing such dialogue.

Xiao Bai froze for two seconds, then suddenly her cheeks turned bright red. "Sister Liang, you've changed!"

Liang Shi smiled awkwardly. "Have I...?"

"You have changed." Wang Zhaozhao stood there and said, "You're already interpreting people's normal conversation as flirting."

Liang Shi retorted: "...It's because you two were driving too fast."

"It's because you're thinking too much." Xiao Bai clicked her tongue. "I'm straight!"

Wang Zhaozhao scoffed lightly. "Who isn't?"

Liang Shi: "..."

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1. Three Good Student (三好學生, Sān Hǎo Xuéshēng): An honorary title given to outstanding students in China who excel in three areas: moral character, academic performance, and physical fitness. It's a common school award. ↵
 2. Bodhisattva descending to save all living beings (菩薩下凡普度眾生): A Buddhist expression referring to enlightened beings who compassionately come down to the mortal world to help suffering people. Xiao Bai is humorously exaggerating that Liang Shi cooking is as miraculous as divine intervention. ↵
 3. Starving ghost reincarnated (餓死鬼投胎): A common Chinese expression used to tease someone who eats ravenously or is extremely eager for food. In Chinese folk beliefs, starving ghosts are spirits who died of hunger and are eternally famished. ↵
 4. Flirting / "driving" (開車): Chinese internet slang where "driving" (開車) refers to making suggestive or flirtatious remarks. The phrase "driving too fast" (車速太快) means the conversation became too suggestive too quickly. ↵